ROLE FIT ANALYSIS

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This is the assessment I would run on any candidate for a role I was hiring, applied to myself against the Queensland Academy of Sport role description. The QAS Applicant Kit asks applicants to reflect on how their approach matches the QAS values as well as the role, so the values come first here and the role specifics follow. Each criterion is rated plainly and the gaps are named where they exist, because the role should go to somebody who can carry the parts that matter most from the start.

STRONG | SOLID | PARTIAL | GAP | MET

16 STRONG · 3 SOLID · 3 PARTIAL · 6 MET ACROSS 28 CRITERIA

WHERE THE FIT IS STRONGEST

The strongest match is in the QAS values and in the people half of the role. Working beside coaches, leading interdisciplinary performance teams and turning athlete data into decisions the coach can use are the parts of this position I have done repeatedly in different sports and countries.

WHERE I WOULD NEED TO GROW

The gaps sit in the Australian Olympic sport system rather than in the work itself. I have not used the What It Takes To Win frameworks, worked inside NSO and SSO partnerships or operated in the Queensland public sector. I would close each by listening first to the coaches, NSO staff and Senior High Performance Manager who already hold that knowledge.

A. QAS VALUES AND BEHAVIOURS

CONSIDERED FIRST, AS THE APPLICANT KIT ASKS

Start with the athlete — STRONG

People First is one of my own values and I have always held that in performance support the athlete is a person first and an athlete second. My planning has been built around the individual athlete, most clearly at the Crusaders where All Blacks and Māori All Blacks commitments were held with Super Rugby as one plan. My players association work covers duty of care, rest and recovery policy and the standards clubs provide for their players.

Our people. Our superpower. — STRONG

The question I keep returning to is who looks after the people who look after everyone. I have written that workload visibility, development planning and recovery protection apply to coaches and staff as much as to athletes. At the Red Sox I designed a 360 degree coaching feedback process for sixteen practitioners and co-authored a proposal to extend performance science to coaching and support staff.

Freedom to fly. Embrace the responsibility. — STRONG

Meaning Over Status and the belief that a department is a set of conditions rather than a person sit close to this value. The Red Sox system depends on practitioners who work autonomously while being clear about what they own. The adjustment for me would be working inside that trust from the other side, as an individual contributor to a Senior High Performance Manager after several years leading departments.

Be curious. Be courageous. — STRONG

Rigour is Respect is the third value I hold, where clarity, honesty and intentional development are how care shows up. Moving from rugby union into Major League Baseball meant learning a new sport and a very different system at major league level. I have hosted two supported PhDs and this analysis names its own gaps for the same reason.

United by excellence — STRONG

I work from the principle of one organisation rather than two, with coaching, performance and support staff held as a single team. The Crusaders titles from 2017 to 2020 were won by an integrated program working to season themes the group helped build. My advisory work in Brazil and Singapore and with players associations in the United States has relied on the same collaboration across organisations.

B. WHAT YOU CAN EXPECT IN THIS ROLE

IN ROLE DESCRIPTION ORDER

Athlete and program plans aligned with NSO What It Takes To Win frameworks — PARTIAL

Building athlete and program plans with coaches and performance teams is long standing work, including national physical standards for the Brazilian and Singapore unions and physical development benchmarks at the Red Sox. I have not worked with the What It Takes To Win frameworks themselves, so their use in Queensland programs would be early learning.

Managing programs through performance team meetings, interdisciplinary collaboration and resource investment — STRONG

I have led interdisciplinary departments at the Crusaders, AG Rugby and the Western Force. Each covered medical and performance support disciplines, with performance team meetings and clear accountability for actions as the standing rhythm of the program. Resource investment has been part of each role through departmental budgets and staffing decisions.

Collaborating across NSOs, SSOs, QAS and system partners — PARTIAL

Working across organisations is established in my career through national unions in Brazil and Singapore, Rugby Australia and players associations in the United States. I have not worked within the Australian NSO and SSO structure for Olympic and Paralympic sports, so those relationships would be built from the start.

Coach development through performance reviews and development planning — STRONG

Performance reviews and development planning for practitioners have been part of every role I have led, most recently through a 360 degree coaching feedback process at the Red Sox. Coach and practitioner development is the priority function of my current Red Sox role. My development work with technical coaches has been through mentoring national coaches in Singapore and working alongside head coaches rather than as their formal reviewer.

B. WHAT YOU CAN EXPECT IN THIS ROLE CONTINUED

IN ROLE DESCRIPTION ORDER

Monitoring athlete performance and refining training plans with data and actionable insight — STRONG

I have designed testing protocols and physical development reporting across three organisations and hosted two supported doctoral projects inside performance programs. Data is used to inform the coach and the athlete rather than to replace their judgement.

Operational planning, program reviews, budgets, competition resources and reporting — SOLID

I have held departmental budgets and operational planning at the Crusaders, AG Rugby, the Western Force and the Red Sox alongside regular reporting to coaches and executives. Reporting within a public sector accountability cycle would be new to me.

Domestic and international travel to camps and competitions — MET

My work has involved touring, campaign and multi site travel across six countries for two decades. I am able to travel domestically and internationally as the programs require.

C. WHAT WE ARE LOOKING FOR

SKILLS, ABILITIES AND QUALIFICATIONS

Experience in high performance sports organisations supporting coaches with empathy — STRONG

I have worked inside high performance organisations for twenty years in rugby union and Major League Baseball, beginning in the High Performance Sport New Zealand network. The role of performance support has always been to serve the coach and the athlete rather than to lead them.

Elite performance strategies drawing on physical, technical, tactical and psychological factors — STRONG

My depth is in the physical factors and in integrating medical, nutrition and mental performance staff around them. Drawing on all of these elements and getting the most from the experts who hold them through alignment is one of my core strengths. Technical and tactical knowledge has come through working alongside head coaches rather than holding those areas myself, so I would expect the coach to lead them.

Building trust and alignment with diverse stakeholders — STRONG

I have built working relationships across clubs, national bodies, players associations and executives in six countries. At the Western Force I was a regular sounding board for coaches, managers and executives beyond my own department.

Developing and achieving objectives aligned with strategic goals — SOLID

I formed the club strategic plan at AG Rugby, contributed to the plan at the Crusaders and mapped the high performance support strategies within strategic planning at the Western Force. Turning those strategies into standards, benchmarks and reporting is the daily mechanism of my current role.

Timely, objective and concise advice to inform management — STRONG

Written advice to executives is a regular part of my work, including a leadership proposal to Boston Red Sox executives and a formal proposal to New Zealand Rugby for a Head of Performance Support function. I aim to keep advice short and objective, with the evidence and the options visible to the decision maker.

Relevant degree in sport science or coaching (highly regarded) — MET

I hold a Bachelor of Sport and Recreation from AUT University (2006) along with the NSCA Certified Strength and Conditioning Specialist (CSCS) and Registered Strength and Conditioning Coach (RSCC) credentials. I do not hold a postgraduate degree.

Individual Contributor level of the Leadership competencies for Queensland — PARTIAL

I have not worked within the Queensland public sector and have not been assessed against this framework before. The behaviours it describes for individual contributors match how I have worked, although the public sector setting around them would be new.

D. IMPORTANT INFORMATION FOR APPLICANTS

ELIGIBILITY AND SCREENING

Right to work in Australia — MET

I am an Australian permanent resident and New Zealand citizen. Evidence of my work rights is supplied with this application.

Blue Card and criminal history check — MET

I will apply for a Queensland Blue Card and consent to the criminal history check before commencement. I have not worked in the Queensland public sector or as a lobbyist.

Referee with knowledge of my work within the previous two years — MET

Chris Goodman managed me directly as General Manager High Performance at the Western Force until December 2024, which gives an Australian reference from within the past two years. A reference from the Boston Red Sox is available on request.

Gold Coast location and fixed term to 28 February 2029 — MET

I am ready to relocate from Perth to the Gold Coast and to commit to the full fixed term, which spans the Los Angeles 2028 cycle.

E. CORE CRITERIA IN THE ADVERTISEMENT

ADDRESSED DIRECTLY

Proven experience at the highest levels of high performance sport — STRONG

I led the Crusaders performance department across four Super Rugby championship seasons and now hold the physical performance system for a Major League Baseball organisation.

Understanding what athletes need to perform on the international stage — SOLID

Touring campaigns with the Māori All Blacks, world championship windows with New Zealand Under 20 and annual planning around All Blacks commitments have shown me what international competition asks of athletes. Olympic Games preparation would be new to me in its specifics.

Working effectively with coaches, athletes and multidisciplinary performance teams — STRONG

This has been the centre of every role I have held, from delivery alongside coaches at Tasman to leading integrated departments at the Crusaders, AG Rugby and the Western Force.

Objective advice, support and constructive challenge — STRONG

I give coaches and managers objective advice with the evidence visible and raise constructive challenge early rather than let caution compound into inaction. At the Western Force I was a regular sounding board for coaches, managers and executives beyond my department.

Balancing daily athlete and program needs with longer term performance goals — STRONG

At the Crusaders the weekly Super Rugby program and the international commitments of each athlete were held as one annual plan. I protect time to step back from daily operation so the longer term performance goals stay in view.

FIRST SIXTY DAYS

DIAGNOSTIC BEFORE RECOMMENDATION

This section is not an attempt to get ahead of the process or presume an appointment. It is here to show how I would think about the role before anyone spends time on my application. The runway is sixty days because I integrate into new environments quickly and contribute from the start while listening and learning.

WEEKS 1 TO 2 **LISTEN**

I would spend time with the athletes, coaches and performance teams in my programs alongside working sessions with the Senior High Performance Manager on priorities and expectations.

WEEKS 2 TO 4 **CONNECT**

I would meet the NSO and SSO high performance staff for each sport and the QAS performance support leads to understand how the system works from inside it.

WEEKS 3 TO 6 **MAP**

I would map each athlete and program plan against its What It Takes To Win framework, the competition calendar and the resources invested towards Los Angeles 2028.

WEEKS 7 TO 8 **SET DIRECTION**

I would agree program plans, review cadence and reporting with the Senior High Performance Manager and the coaches who will carry them.

QUESTIONS I WOULD BRING

- Which sports and programs would this role hold and how are they shared across the team of seven?
- Where does QAS own the athlete and program plan and where does it support a plan held by the NSO?
- How are coach performance reviews run across the network and who holds the formal review?
- How does the Youfor2032 talent identification program connect with the programs this role manages?
- How are resource investment decisions made within a program and reviewed across the year?

PRACTICALITIES

RIGHT TO WORK	Australian permanent resident · New Zealand citizen
LOCATION	Relocating from Perth to the Gold Coast
AVAILABILITY	From October 2026
TRAVEL	Domestic and international as required
SCREENING	Will apply for a Blue Card and consent to a criminal history check
REFERENCES	Chris Goodman named · Boston Red Sox reference on request
TERM	Committed to the fixed term to 28 February 2029

IN CLOSING

I am applying because this role would put my experience back beside the coach and the athlete in a system with a clear purpose through to 2032. I would bring the rigour of this analysis to the work and the humility to learn the parts of the system that are new to me.